Trastuzumab IV · every 3 weeks

IV trastuzumab every 21 days. Early breast cancer: complete one year total, allowing for earlier trastuzumab. Metastatic disease: continue while beneficial and tolerated; no automatic one-year stop.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Breathing

Trastuzumab

New cough or breathlessness: seek prompt assessment.

2 Heart

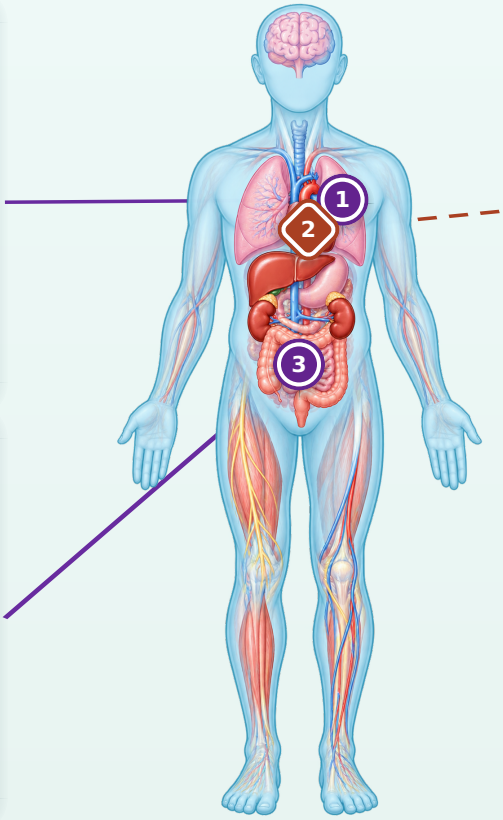
Trastuzumab

Keep echo checks. Report swelling, chest symptoms, fainting or rapid weight gain.

3 Bowel / fatigue

Trastuzumab

Report persistent diarrhoea, dehydration or fatigue affecting daily activity.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Trastuzumab

- Heart pumping-function reduction / heart failure
- Infusion or allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Support for this medicine

Trastuzumab alone has minimal emetogenic risk. Routine chemotherapy antiemetics, steroids and growth factors are not added automatically. Previous reactions require a separate plan.

Blood and heart appointments

Baseline FBC, renal and liver profile; repeat blood tests according to the team / companion-regimen plan (NCCP does not assign a universal interval here). Echo / MUGA every 12 weeks; around C5 for uninterrupted 21-day cycles.

Local treatment and endocrine therapy

Surgery and radiotherapy are coordinated by the MDT. When endocrine therapy is indicated, it has its own schedule and bone-health plan.

Pregnancy / contraception

Discuss pregnancy, fertility and contraception before treatment. Report pregnancy promptly; do not breastfeed during treatment or for 7 months afterwards. The team confirms the medicine-specific contraception duration.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00200/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.